9.10 Role of Nursing in Disasters

"Disaster preparedness, including risk assessment and multi-disciplinary management strategies at all system levels, is critical to the delivery of effective responses to the short, medium, and long-term health needs of a disaster-stricken population." (International Council of Nurses, 2006)

Major Roles of Nurse in Disasters

1. Determine magnitude of the event
2. Define health needs of the affected groups
3. Establish priorities and objectives
4. Identify actual and potential public health problems
5. Determine resources needed to respond to the needs identified
6. Collaborate with other professional disciplines, governmental and non-governmental agencies
7. Maintain a unified chain of command
8. Communication

Consider These Facts

- 25% of all emergency room visits can be avoided with basic first aid and CPR certification
- Sudden cardiac arrest represents 13% of all workplace deaths
- Nearly 5 million workers were injured on the job in 2012, costing companies $198.2 billion
- 75% of all out-of-hospital heart attacks happen at home

SUMMARY

- First aid is the initial assistance or treatment given to a casualty for any injury or sudden illness. The First aid is not an end by itself. It indicates that the person is in need of a "Secondary Aid"
- A simple way to remember the aims of first aid is to think of the **"Three Ps"-Preserve / Prevent / Promote**.
- A wound is an injury in which the skin is cut or penetrated.
- Bleeding, technically known as hemorrhaging, is the loss of blood escaping from the circulatory system.
- first aid mnemonic **PEEP** to remember how to deal with a severe bleeds. **P**osition, **E**xpose & examine, **E**levation, **P**ressure.
- Shock is a syndrome that results from a decrease in effective circulating blood volume in the body as a result of injury or illness
- Shock, a potentially life-threatening condition in which the organs and tissues of the body are not receiving an adequate flow of blood.
- To manage severe injuries follow. **DRSABCD**
- A break or crack in a bone is called a fracture.

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